

Ready for the shot: Avani Lekhara will compete in three events: the women's 10m air rifle standing SH1, the mixed 10m air rifle prone SH1, and the women's 50m 3-position rifle SH1. AP

medals across all previous Paralympic appearances, with four of each colour.

India first-ever Paralympic medal came at the 1972 Games when Murlikant Petkar won the 50m freestyle event with a then-world record time of 37.331s.

This year, India is set to make a significant leap in its representation at the Paris Paralympics. In Tokyo, India sent 54 athletes, including just 14 women.

For Paris, the team has expanded to 84 athletes, with women making up 32 participants. Out of the 84 athletes, 50 of them feature in the Target Olympic Podium Scheme (TOPS) core list.

However, not all familiar faces will be present. Reigning Paralympic and World champion Pramod Bhagat, who won gold in the men's singles SL3 category, has been excluded after being found guilty of breaching the Badminton World Federation's (BWF) anti-doping regulations due to three whereabouts failures within a 12-month period.

Ekta Bhyan, who finished eighth in the women's club throw F51 at the Tokyo Games and clinched gold in the same event at the World Para Athletics Championships 2024, did not make the list for Paris, as her event is not included in the Paralympic roster.

Additionally, double Paralympic medallist shooter Singhraj Adhana

misses out due to new competition rules from the International Paralympic Committee, which now allow only two shooters per event, as opposed to three in Tokyo.

At the Tokyo Games, the 42-year-old Adhana had won silver



On target: Manish Narwal (in pic) and Nihal Singh will take the final quotas for the men's 10m air pistol SH1 and mixed 50m pistol SH1 events, respectively. PTI

in the mixed 50m pistol SH1 and bronze in the men's 10m air pistol SH1 categories.

In Paris, Rudransh Khandelwal will compete in the same events, while Manish Narwal and Nihal Singh will take the final quotas for the men's 10m air pistol SH1 and mixed 50m pistol SH1 events, respectively.

Despite these changes, four out of India's five defending Paralympic

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